《国际象棋中局计划》

B：格子 - 2：“永恒之马”

英文 OCR 校正稿 + 中文翻译校对稿

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重点核对“永恒之马”的术语、五组例局或片段、棋手译名和全部分析变例。

B：格子 - 2：“永恒之马”

经校正的英文 OCR	中文译文
EK-1 When a knight occupies an impregnable position on a weak square in the centre or in the opponent's camp, it becomes particularly strong. Not for nothing do we give such a piece the graphic name "eternal" knight. We will look at a few examples in which the "eternal" knight decides the outcome of the struggle. The following position arose after the move 18. Qe3 in the game Izmailov-Kasparyan, played in the semi-final of the 7th USSR Championship (1931). 18... Bxf3 Also possible was 18... Bf5, when 19. g4? Nf4 is bad for White, since the knight firmly occupies the weak square. White would have to reply 19. Nh4, so that after 19... Nf4 he could boldly continue 20. O-O-O. 19. Qxf3 After capturing with the queen, White must play accurately to prevent the opponent from obtaining an "eternal" knight by transferring it along the route ...Ng7-f5-d4. After 19. Bxf3 Ng7 20. Be4, Black would hardly have achieved this objective. 19... Qe7 20. Qe4 Ng7 21. h4 Nf5 22. h5? A weak move which delays the knight's invasion of d4 only briefly. White could have obtained counter-chances with 22. Bg4 Nd4 23. O-O-O, or the quieter 23. O-O, preparing f4. 22... Qg5 23. Rd1 Rf8 24. Qg4 White should not head for an endgame, in which under the present circumstances it is much easier for Black to realise the advantage of the "eternal" knight. 24... Qxg4 25. Bxg4 Nd4 The objective has now been achieved! 26. Kf1 a4 27. a3 c5 28. Rd2 b5 29. cxb5 Nxb5 30. Be6+ Kg7 31. hxg6 hxg6 32. Kg2 Nd4 33. Bg4 Rfb8 34. Re1 Ra7 35. Bd1 Kf6 36. f4 exf4 37. gxf4 Rh8 Threatening ...Rah7 with a dangerous attack. White has to go in for further exchanges. 38. Rh1 Rxh1 39. Kxh1 Kf5 40. Rg2 Kxf4 41. Rxg6 Ke5 42. Rg5+ Ke4 43. Rh5 Ra8 44. Kg1 Rb8 45. Bxa4 Rxb2 46. Kf1 Ke3 47. Rh3+ Nf3 0-1	**EK-1** 当一匹马占据中心或对方阵地内一个无法攻破的弱格时，它会变得格外强大。我们把这样的棋子形象地称为“永恒之马”，并非没有道理。 下面考察几个由“永恒之马”决定斗争结果的例子。 图示局面产生于伊兹迈洛夫对卡斯帕里扬一局，比赛为1931年第7届苏联锦标赛半决赛；此前白方刚走了18. Qe3。 18... Bxf3 也可以走18... Bf5。此时白方若走19. g4?并不好，因为19... Nf4之后，黑马将牢牢占据弱格。白方必须走19. Nh4，以便在19... Nf4后大胆走20. O-O-O。 19. Qxf3 白方用后吃回以后必须精确行棋，阻止对手沿……Ng7-f5-d4的路线调马，造出“永恒之马”。若19. Bxf3 Ng7 20. Be4，黑方就很难实现这一目标。 19... Qe7 20. Qe4 Ng7 21. h4 Nf5 22. h5? 这是一着弱棋，只能短暂延缓黑马侵入d4。白方本可走22. Bg4 Nd4 23. O-O-O取得反击机会；较为平静的23. O-O也可以，并准备f4冲兵。 22... Qg5 23. Rd1 Rf8 24. Qg4 白方不应主动进入残局，因为在当前条件下，黑方更容易兑现“永恒之马”带来的优势。 24... Qxg4 25. Bxg4 Nd4 目标终于实现了！ 26. Kf1 a4 27. a3 c5 28. Rd2 b5 29. cxb5 Nxb5 30. Be6+ Kg7 31. hxg6 hxg6 32. Kg2 Nd4 33. Bg4 Rfb8 34. Re1 Ra7 35. Bd1 Kf6 36. f4 exf4 37. gxf4 Rh8 黑方威胁……Rah7，发动危险的进攻。白方只得继续寻求交换。 38. Rh1 Rxh1 39. Kxh1 Kf5 40. Rg2 Kxf4 41. Rxg6 Ke5 42. Rg5+ Ke4 43. Rh5 Ra8 44. Kg1 Rb8 45. Bxa4 Rxb2 46. Kf1 Ke3 47. Rh3+ Nf3 0-1

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EK-2
Spanish Game
 	
White: G. Levenfish
Black: P. Dubinin
9th USSR Championship, 1934
 	
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Bb5 d6
 	
By a transposition of moves, a variation of the Steinitz Defence with the knight on f6 has been obtained. In this variation Black gets a rather cramped position, but practice has shown that it is difficult for White to exploit the small advantage gained in the centre.
 	
5. d4 exd4
 	
An unjustified exchange. The correct reply was 5... Bd7. True, Black would later have to exchange on d4 in that case as well, but only after mobilising his principal forces and preparing to castle.
 	
6. Nxd4 Bd7 7. Bxc6 bxc6
 	
Black endeavours to retain his light-squared bishop. After 7... Bxc6 8. Nxc6 bxc6 9. Qf3 Qd7 10. h3 Be7 11. Bf4 O-O 12. O-O, followed by Rad1 and Rfe1, it is difficult for him to withstand the concentrated attack of all the opponent's pieces.
 	
8. Qf3
 	
This active development of the queen, with the potential threat e5, has become possible only as a consequence of Black's fifth move.
 	
8... c5
 	
If 8... Be7, then 9. e5 dxe5 10. Nxc6 Bxc6 11. Qxc6+ Nd7 12. Nd5 Bd6 13. Bg5 f6 14. Be3 O-O 15. O-O, and by following with Rd1 White consolidates his achievement in the centre. The c6 and d5 squares are real weaknesses.
 	
9. Nf5 Bxf5
 	
All the same, Black has to exchange the light-squared bishop. The knight on f5 is very strongly posted and prevents castling, and consequently also the mobilisation of Black's forces. It cannot be driven back by 9... g6 because of 10. Bg5 gxf5 11. e5 dxe5 12. Bxf6 e4 13. Nxe4. These variations show the strength of the queen's position on f3 before Black has castled.
 	
10. Qxf5 Qd7 11. Qf3 Rb8 12. O-O Be7 13. b3 O-O
 	
Black must now keep the light squares under constant control. The principal role in carrying out this task falls to the knight, so he must avoid exchanging it for the enemy bishop for as long as possible. Otherwise the task of defence would fall entirely upon the pawns. For example, ...c6 is required to defend d5, but it severely weakens d6; ...g6, defending f5, creates new weaknesses in the castled position. From this point of view Black's last move is inaccurate. The exchange of bishop for knight enters into White's plan, and it would have been useful to forestall it with 13... h6.
	EK-2
	西班牙开局
	
	白方：G. 列文菲什
	黑方：P. 杜比宁
	1934年第9届苏联锦标赛
	
	`1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Bb5 d6`
	
	经过招法次序转换，棋局进入了马位于f6的斯坦尼茨防御变例。黑方在这个变例中局面相当局促，但实践表明，白方也很难利用自己在中心取得的微小优势。
	
	`5. d4 exd4`
	
	这次交换缺乏依据。正确的是`5... Bd7`。诚然，这样黑方以后仍须在d4交换，但那是在主要子力已经出动并做好王车易位准备之后。
	
	`6. Nxd4 Bd7 7. Bxc6 bxc6`
	
	黑方试图保留白格象。若`7... Bxc6 8. Nxc6 bxc6 9. Qf3 Qd7 10. h3 Be7 11. Bf4 O-O 12. O-O`，随后Rad1和Rfe1，黑方将很难抵挡白方全部子力的集中攻击。
	
	`8. Qf3`
	
	这次积极出后，并酝酿e5冲兵的威胁，完全是黑方第5回合造成的结果。
	
	`8... c5`
	
	若`8... Be7`，则`9. e5 dxe5 10. Nxc6 Bxc6 11. Qxc6+ Nd7 12. Nd5 Bd6 13. Bg5 f6 14. Be3 O-O 15. O-O`，随后走Rd1，白方即可巩固自己在中心的成果。c6和d5都是真正的弱格。
	
	`9. Nf5 Bxf5`
	
	黑方终究不得不用白格象换马。f5马位置极佳，不仅阻止黑王易位，也因此妨碍黑方子力出动。黑方不能走`9... g6`赶马，因为有`10. Bg5 gxf5 11. e5 dxe5 12. Bxf6 e4 13. Nxe4`。这些变化说明，在黑王尚未易位时，白后位于f3的力量十分强大。
	
	`10. Qxf5 Qd7 11. Qf3 Rb8 12. O-O Be7 13. b3 O-O`
	
	黑方现在必须持续控制白格。执行这一任务的主角是马，所以应尽可能避免让它与对方的象交换；否则防守任务就会全部落到兵的身上。例如，为防守d5必须走……c6，但这会严重削弱d6；为防守f5走……g6，又会在王翼易位阵地中制造新的弱点。从这一角度看，黑方

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	上一着并不准确。象换马正中白方计划，黑方本应以13... h6预先制止。

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EK-3 14. Bg5 White consistently carries out his plan. True, he does not yet threaten to take the knight, but after 15. Rad1 the threat of exchange becomes unpleasant. 14... Nd5? Astonishingly, Black himself meets his opponent's wishes! If the knight is to move, 14... Ne8 is better, although this too breaks the communication between the black rooks. Nevertheless, after 14... Ne8 15. Bxe7 Qxe7 16. Nd5 Qe6, Black could defend himself with some success, retaining the possibility of ...c6, while the king's rook enters the game by ...f6 and ...Rf7. In this defensive plan the knight would play a major role, covering c7, d6 and g7. There was another way to counter White's plan: 14... h6 and, after 15. Bh4, 15... g5 16. Bg3 Rfe8. The drawback is the considerable weakening of the kingside, especially f5, but in return Black would obtain an object of attack in the e4-pawn. 15. Nxd5 Bxg5 16. Qg3 Bd8 17. Rad1 f5? Another mistake, after which the white knight on d5 becomes "eternal". Black's position is admittedly very difficult. After 17... c6 18. Ne3 the weakness on d6 is irreparable; yet without ...c6 it is difficult for Black to develop play, since the knight on d5 paralyses all his activity. 18. e5! Re8 After 18... c6 19. Nf6+ Bxf6 20. Rxd6 Qc7 21. exf6 Rxf6 22. Rxf6, the ending is miserable for Black, but this was the lesser evil. 19. exd6 cxd6 White has successfully completed the first part of his plan: he has an "eternal" knight in the centre. This advantage is fully sufficient for victory. The struggle now approaches the concluding stage, in which the advantage is realised. Supported by the powerful position of the "eternal" knight, White develops an irresistible attack on the kingside. 20. Rfe1 Re6 21. Nf4 Rxe1+ 22. Rxe1 Ba5 23. Nd5 Bd8 24. h4 Rb7 25. c4 Kf7 26. Qf3 Kg8 27. Qe2 Threatening to win the bishop with Qe8+. The reply 27... Bxh4 is impossible because of 28. Qh5. 27... g6 28. h5 Kf8 29. h6 Intending Qb2. There were other ways as well, for example 29. Qb2 at once, or 29. hxg6 hxg6 30. Nf4.	EK-3 14. Bg5 白方连贯地执行自己的计划。眼下虽还没有吃马的直接威胁，但走过Rad1之后，交换威胁就会令黑方难受。 14... Nd5? 令人惊讶的是，黑方竟主动迎合了对手的愿望！如果一定要动马，14... Ne8更好，虽然这也会割断黑方双车的联系。不过，14... Ne8 15. Bxe7 Qxe7 16. Nd5 Qe6之后，黑方仍可相当成功地防守：既保留……c6的可能，也可以走……f6和……Rf7使王车投入战斗。在这一防守计划中，黑马将承担重要任务，控制c7、d6和g7。 黑方还有另一种对抗白方计划的方法：14... h6 15. Bh4 g5 16. Bg3 Rfe8。这一路变化的缺点是王翼、尤其f5格被明显削弱；作为补偿，黑方可以把e4兵作为攻击目标。 15. Nxd5 Bxg5 16. Qg3 Bd8 17. Rad1 f5? 又一处错误，使d5白马成为“永恒之马”。不过黑方的局面的确十分困难。若17... c6 18. Ne3，d6弱点便无法补救；但不走……c6又很难展开行动，因为d5马压制了黑方的全部活动。 18. e5! Re8 若18... c6 19. Nf6+ Bxf6 20. Rxd6 Qc7 21. exf6 Rxf6 22. Rxf6，黑方的残局非常痛苦，但这已经是较小的灾难。 19. exd6 cxd6 白方顺利完成了计划的第一阶段：他在中心安置了一匹“永恒之马”。这一优势已经完全足以制胜。 斗争进入兑现优势的最后阶段。依托“永恒之马”的强大位置，白方向黑王发动了无法抵挡的进攻。 20. Rfe1 Re6 21. Nf4 Rxe1+ 22. Rxe1 Ba5 23. Nd5 Bd8 24. h4 Rb7 25. c4 Kf7 26. Qf3 Kg8 27. Qe2 白方威胁Qe8+得象。黑方不能走27... Bxh4，因为有28. Qh5。 27... g6 28. h5 Kf8 29. h6

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29... Bg5 Black does not even stop the threat. His last hope was 29... Qf7, but after 30. Qd3 a5 31. Nf4 he would not have been able to resist for long either. 30. Qb2 Kg8 31. f4 Bd8 32. Nf6+ A beautiful conclusion! Of course, Re7 or Ne7+ was also sufficient. 32... Bxf6 33. Qxf6 d5 34. cxd5 1-0 After 34... Rb6 follows 35. Re8+.	准备Qb2。白方还有其他方法，例如立即走29. Qb2，或走29. hxg6 hxg6 30. Nf4。 29... Bg5 黑方甚至没有制止威胁。最后的希望是29... Qf7，但30. Qd3 a5 31. Nf4以后同样坚持不了多久。 30. Qb2 Kg8 31. f4 Bd8 32. Nf6+ 漂亮的收尾！当然，Re7或Ne7+也足以取胜。 32... Bxf6 33. Qxf6 d5 34. cxd5 1-0 若34... Rb6，则35. Re8+。

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EK-4 In the 16th game of the 1951 world championship match between Bronstein and Botvinnik, the following position was reached. Without examining the concrete purpose of Black's last move, 46... Qe8, Bronstein played: 47. Qd3? There followed: 47... Bxf4 48. exf4 Bh5! Bronstein was faced with a difficult choice. After 49. Bg2 Qa8, an invasion by the enemy pieces on the a-file is threatened, while the knight occupies a menacing central position on e4. After 49. Bxe4 dxe4 50. Qa3 Bf3+ 51. Kg1 Qh5 52. Qe3 Qh3 53. Qf2 h5, the threat ...h4 is irresistible. Bronstein decides to allow Black an "eternal" knight, while trying to obtain some compensation by occupying the a-file. 49. Qa3 Bxf3+ 50. Rxf3 Rg7 Defending the b7-pawn against a possible attack by the queen. There is nothing in 50... Qa8, since White will not exchange but will reply 51. Rd3, adhering to waiting tactics. The tactical diversion 50... Qh5 likewise leads to nothing after 51. Kg2. Black's plan is first to create a few more weak points in the opponent's camp, for example by provoking h4; then, by attacking them, to divert White's pieces from defence of the a-file; and finally to occupy this important strategic avenue of invasion. With the support of the "eternal" knight, it will then not be difficult to deliver the concluding blow. 51. Kg2 Qd8 52. Kf1 Qf6 53. Rd3 h5 54. h4	EK-4 在布龙斯坦与鲍特维尼克1951年世界冠军赛的第16局中，形成了图示局面。 布龙斯坦没有深入考察黑方上一着46... Qe8的具体目的，便走了： 47. Qd3? 接下来： 47... Bxf4 48. exf4 Bh5! 布龙斯坦面临艰难选择。若49. Bg2 Qa8，黑方就威胁沿a线入侵，同时e4马在中心占据咄咄逼人的位置；若49. Bxe4 dxe4 50. Qa3 Bf3+ 51. Kg1 Qh5 52. Qe3 Qh3 53. Qf2 h5，则……h4的威胁无法抵挡。 布龙斯坦决定允许黑方造出“永恒之马”，同时试图通过占领a线取得一些补偿。 49. Qa3 Bxf3+ 50. Rxf3 Rg7 防守b7兵，以免白后攻击。50... Qa8没有意义，因为白方不会交换，而会走51. Rd3，继续等待。战术性的50... Qh5在51. Kg2之后同样一无所获。 黑方的计划是：先在对方阵地中再制造几个弱点，例如诱使白方冲起h4；然后通过攻击这些弱点，使白方子力离开a线的防守；最后占领这条重要的战略入侵通道。在“永恒之马”的支援下，最后一击便不难完成。

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Of course White cannot allow ...h4.
 	
54... Rg8
 	
Intending, after ...Qg7, to keep the d4-pawn under attack and create the threat of invasion via g4.
 	
55. Rd1
 	
This somewhat eases Black's realisation of his positional advantage, but what can White do? If 55. Qa7, then 55... Qg7 and White is in zugzwang. 56. Qb6 is impossible because of 56... Ra8, while retreating the queen along the a-file is met by ...Qg4.
 	
55... Qg7 56. Qf3 Kh6 57. Kg2 Ra8, and Black won.
	`51. Kg2 Qd8 52. Kf1 Qf6 53. Rd3 h5 54. h4`
	
	白方当然不能允许……h4。
	
	`54... Rg8`
	
	黑方准备走……Qg7，在继续攻击d4兵的同时，制造经g4侵入的威胁。
	
	`55. Rd1`
	
	这使黑方兑现局面优势稍微容易了一些，但白方又能怎么办？若`55. Qa7 Qg7`，白方就陷入楚茨文克。`56. Qb6`因`56... Ra8`而不成立；白后若沿a线后退，则有……Qg4。
	
	`55... Qg7 56. Qf3 Kh6 57. Kg2 Ra8`，黑方获胜。

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EK-5
The struggle was decided by the "eternal" knight in the game Terpugov-Bronstein (19th USSR Championship, 1951):
 	
30. Rb2 Ndc5 31. Nxc5 Qxc5 32. f6?
 	
Not only a useless move, since the queen's raid Qh6 is repulsed by ...Qf8, but also a serious positional miscalculation. It is clear that Black dreams of transferring the knight to the invulnerable d4-square. With his last move White himself removes control from e6, a transit point on the route to this cherished objective. It is not surprising that he soon suffers defeat.
 	
Yet White's position was not altogether bad. Several active possibilities were available. Worth considering, for example, was the advance of the h-pawn. After 32. h4 it is dangerous for Black to take the c4-pawn with the queen because of 33. Rc1. White intends to continue h5, Bh3 and Rf1, applying pressure on the kingside.
 	
32... Nc7 33. Ra4 Na6 34. Qh6
 	
Another unnecessary thrust, helping Black carry out his plan even sooner. The rook is badly placed on a4, as soon becomes clear; it should simply have retraced its steps.
 	
34... Qf8 35. Qg5
 	
The exchange of queens simplifies the struggle to Black's advantage. The f6-pawn is very weak, and the plan of invading d4 is not easy to realise, so White naturally tries to complicate matters as much as possible on the kingside.
 	
35... Nc5!
 	
The poor position of White's rook on a4 makes itself felt. It must go back, since 36. Raxb4 Rxb4 37. Rxb4 loses the exchange after 37... Nxe4.
	EK-5
	在特尔普戈夫对布龙斯坦一局（1951年第19届苏联锦标赛）中，“永恒之马”同样决定了斗争结果：
	
	`30. Rb2 Ndc5 31. Nxc5 Qxc5 32. f6?`
	
	这步棋不仅毫无用处——白后的Qh6突袭会被……Qf8挡回——而且是严重的局面误算。显然，黑方正准备把马转移到坚不可摧的d4格；白方上一着却亲自放弃了对e6格的控制，而e6正是黑马通往这一理想据点的中转站。白方很快落败，也就不足为奇了。
	
	其实白方的局面并没有那么糟，他还有若干积极方案。例如可以考虑冲h兵：`32. h4`之后，黑后若吃c4兵，会遭到`33. Rc1`；白方准备继续h5、Bh3和Rf1，在王翼施压。
	
	`32... Nc7 33. Ra4 Na6 34. Qh6`
	
	又一次没有必要的出击，反而帮助黑方更快执行计划。白车在a4位置很差，这一点很快就会显现；它本该原路返回。
	
	`34... Qf8 35. Qg5`
	
	兑后会使斗争朝有利于黑方的方向简化。f6兵很弱，而侵入d4的计划并不容易实现，所以白方自然要尽量在王翼把局面复杂化。
	
	`35... Nc5!`
	
	a4白车的位置不佳开始产生后果。白车必须退回原处，因为`36. Raxb4 Rxb4 37. Rxb4 Nxe4`之后会丢半子。

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36. Ra1 h6 37. Qe3
 	
Of course 37. Qxe5 is impossible because of 37... Nd3.
 	
37... Kh7 38. Rd2 Ne6 39. a6 Rba7 40. Rda2 c5 41. h4 Qd6
 	
On top of everything, White now has trouble with the a6-pawn.
 	
42. h5 g5 43. Qf2 Nd4
 	
The knight every chess player dreams of!
 	
44. Rd2 Kg8
 	
Black intends, after 45... Rxa6 46. Rxa6, to recapture on a6 with the rook; at present that is impossible because of Rxd4, followed by Qf5-c8+ with a draw.
 	
45. Rda2
 	
White sealed this move, but then resigned without resuming play. The decision was correct, since after ...Rxa6 the b-pawn, supported by the "eternal" knight, reaches the first rank without difficulty.
	`36. Ra1 h6 37. Qe3`
	
	当然不能走`37. Qxe5`，因为有`37... Nd3`。
	
	`37... Kh7 38. Rd2 Ne6 39. a6 Rba7 40. Rda2 c5 41. h4 Qd6`
	
	雪上加霜的是，白方现在还得为a6兵操心。
	
	`42. h5 g5 43. Qf2 Nd4`
	
	每个棋手都梦寐以求的一匹马!
	
	`44. Rd2 Kg8`
	
	黑方准备在`45... Rxa6 46. Rxa6`之后用车在a6吃回；眼下这还做不到，因为白方可以Rxd4，随后Qf5-c8+逼和。
	
	`45. Rda2`
	
	白方封存了这步棋，但续赛时没有再下便认输。这一决定是正确的，因为……Rxa6以后，b兵在“永恒之马”的支援下可以毫无困难地抵达第一横线。

附录：原扫描页

以下扫描页保留原书棋盘图、版面和旧式记谱，用于核对 OCR、棋谱与译文。相邻小节共用的边界页会在两份校样中重复收录。

A weak square and a weak point will sometimes be a temporary feature, in so far as the majority of chess processes proceed dynamically and the conditions of the struggle are constantly changing.

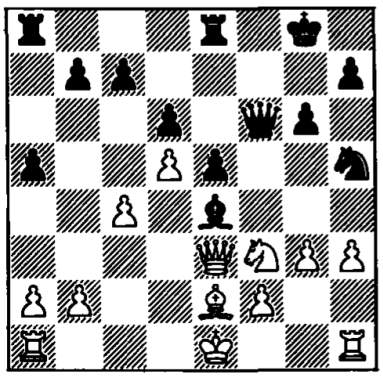
We pass on to a look at planned processes, connected with the struggle for the creation of a weak square, the occupation of it and the realisation of the advantage ensuing from this.

2: The "Eternal" Knight

When a knight occupies an impregnable position on a weak square in the centre or in the opponent's camp, it becomes particularly strong. Not for nothing do we give such a piece the graphic name "eternal" knight.

We will look at a few examples in which the "eternal" knight decides the outcome of the struggle.

The following position arose after the move 18 Qe3 in the game **Izmailov-Kasparyan**, played in the semi-final of the 7th USSR Championship (1931).



18 ... Bxf3

Possible was also 18 ... Bf5, on which bad is 19 g4? Nf4, firmly occupying the weak square. White would have to reply 19 Nh4, so as on 19 ... Nf4 to boldly continue 20 0-0-0.

19 Qxf3

After capturing with the queen, accurate play is required from White to prevent the opponent obtaining the "eternal" knight, by transferring it via the march-route ... Ng7-f5-d4. After 19 Bxf3 Ng7 20 Be4 Black would hardly have achieved this objective.

19 ... Qe7 20 Qe4 Ng7 21 h4 Nf5 22 h5?

A weak move, which only delays for a short while the invasion of the knight on d4. He could have obtained counter-chances by playing 22 Bg4 Nd4 23 0-0-0, or the quieter 23 0-0, preparing f4.

22 ... Qg5 23 Rd1 Rf8 24 Qg4

White should not head for the endgame, where, in the present situation, it is far easier to realise the advantage of the "eternal" knight.

24 ... Qxg4 25 Bxg4 Nd4

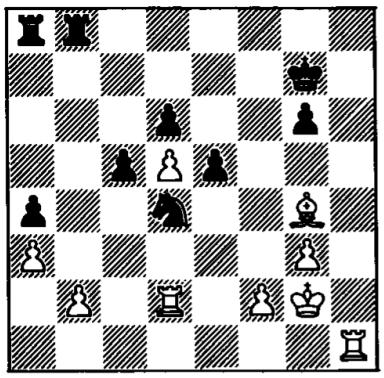
The objective has been now achieved!

26 Kf1 a4 27 a3 c5 28 Rd2 b5 29 cxb5 Nxb5 30 Be6+ Kg7 31 hxg6 hxg6 32 Kg2 Nd4 33 Bg4 Rfb8

(See next diagram)

34 Re1 Ra7 35 Bd1 Kf6 36 f4 exf4 37 gxf4 Rh8

Threatening ... Rah7 with a



dangerous attack. White has to go in for further exchanges.

38 Rh1 Rxh1 39 Kxh1 Kf5 40 Rg2 Kxf4 41 Rxg6 Ke5 42 Rg5+ Ke4 43 Rh5 Ra8 44 Kg1 Rb8 45 Bxa4 Rxb2 46 Kf1 Ke3 47 Rh3+ Nf3 0:1

Spanish Game
White: **G.Levenfish**
Black: **P.Dubinin**
(9th USSR Championship 1934)

1 e4 e5 2 Nf3 Nf6 3 Nc3 Nc6 4 Bb5 d6

By a transposition of moves, a variation of the Steinitz Defence with the position of the knight on f6, has been obtained. In this variation Black gets a rather cramped position, but practice has shown that it is difficult for White to exploit the small advantage he gains in the centre.

5 d4 exd4

An unjustified exchange. The correct reply was 5 ... Bd7. True, also in this case Black would later have to exchange on d4, but this occurs after he has mobilised his principal forces and prepared for castling.

6 Nxd4 Bd7 7 Bxc6 bxc6

Black endeavours to retain his white-squared bishop. In the event of 7 ... Bxc6 8 Nxc6 bxc6 9 Qf3 Qd7 10 h3 Be7 11 Bf4 0-0 12 0-0 followed by Rad1 and Rfe1, it is difficult for him to withstand the concentrated attack of all the opponent's pieces.

8 Qf3

This active development of the queen, with the potential threat of e5, has become possible only as a consequence of Black's 5th move.

8 ... c5

If 8 ... Be7, then 9 e5 dxe5 10 Nxc6 Bxc6 11 Qxc6+ Nd7 12 Nd5 Bd6 13 Bg5 f6 14 Be3 0-0 15 0-0, and by further playing Rd1 White consolidates his achievement in the centre. The c6 and d5 squares are real weaknesses.

9 Nf5 Bxf5

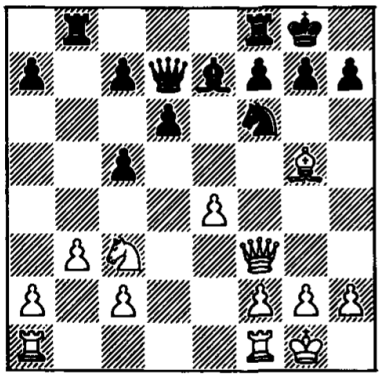
All the same, he has to exchange the white-squared bishop. The knight on f5 is very strongly posted and prevents castling, and as a consequence also the mobilisation of Black's forces. The knight cannot be driven back by 9 ... g6, in view of 10 Bg5 gxf5 11 e5 dxe5 12 Bxf6 e4 13 Nxe4. These variations show the strength of the queen's position on f3 before Black has castled.

10 Qxf5 Qd7 11 Qf3 Rb8 12 0-0 Be7 13 b3 0-0

It is necessary for Black now to keep the white squares under con-

stant control. The main role in the carrying out of this task falls upon the knight, therefore he must avoid the exchange of it for the enemy bishop for as long as possible. You see, in this case, the task of defence lies wholly on the pawns. For example, he has to play ... c6 to defend the d5 square, but this severely weakens the d6 point; the move ... g6, to defend the f5 square, leads to the creation of new weaknesses in the castled position. From this point of view, Black's last move is inaccurate. The exchange of bishop for knight enters into White's plan and it would be useful to forestall it by 13 ... h6.

14 Bg5



White consistently carries out his line. True, he does not yet threaten to take the knight, but after 15 Rad1 the threat of exchange becomes unpleasant.

14 ... Nd5?

Astonishing - Black himself meets his opponent's wishes!

Really, if the knight moves away, then 14 ... Ne8 is better, though this also breaks the communication of the Black rooks. Nevertheless, after 14 ... Ne8 15 Bxe7 Qxe7 16 Nd5 Qe6, Black could defend himself not without success, having left himself the possibility of ... c6, while the king's rook is introduced into play by means of ... f6 and ... Rf7. In this plan of defence, the knight would have played a great role, covering the c7, d6 and g7 points.

There was also another possibility of counteracting White's plan - 14 ... h6 and on 15 Bh4 g5 16 Bg3 Rfe8. The drawback of this continuation is the rather weakened king's flank and in particular the f5 square, but in return Black would have an object of attack - the e4 pawn.

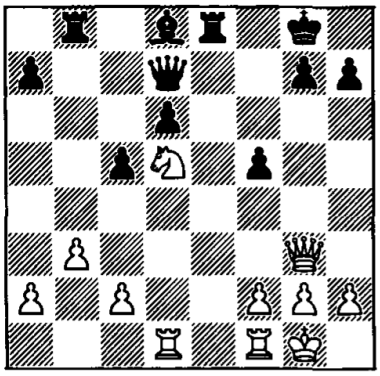
15 Nxd5 Bxg5 16 Qg3 Bd8 17 Rad1 f5?

Yet another mistake, leading to White's knight on d5 becoming "eternal". However, Black's position is very difficult. Bad is 17 ... c6 18 Ne3, and the weakness on d6 is irreparable; but, on the other hand, it is difficult for him to develop play without ... c6, since the knight d5 paralyses all his activity.

18 e5! Re8

Also after 18 ... c6 19 Nf6+ Bxf6 20 Rxd6 Qc7 21 exf6 Rxf6 22 Rxf6 the endgame is miserable for Black, but this was the lesser evil.

19 exd6 cxd6



White has successfully completed the first part of his plan; he has an "eternal" knight in the centre. This advantage is quite sufficient for victory.

The struggle approaches the concluding stage of realisation of the advantage. Supported by the powerful position of the "eternal" knight, White develops an irresistible attack on the king's flank.

20 Rfe1 Re6 21 Nf4 Rxe1+ 22 Rxe1 Ba5 23 Nd5 Bd8 24 h4 Rb7 25 c4 Kf7 26 Qf3 Kg8 27 Qe2

With the threat to win the bishop after Qe8+. The reply 27 ... Bxh4 is not possible because of 28 Qh5.

27 ... g6 28 h5 Kf8 29 h6

With the intention of continuing Qb2. There were also other ways, for example at once 29 Qb2 or 29 hxg6 hxg6 30 Nf4.

29 ... Bg5

Black does not even stop the threat. His last hope was 29 ... Qf7, but after 30 Qd3 a5 31 Nf4 he also would not have been able to resist for long.

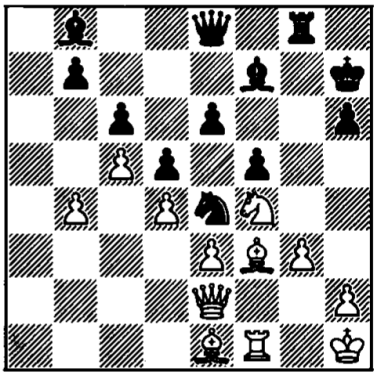
30 Qb2 Kg8 31 f4 Bd8 32 Nf6+

A beautiful conclusion! Of course Re7 or Ne7+ are also sufficient.

32 ... Bxf6 33 Qxf6 d5 34 cxd5 1:0

On 34 ... Rb6 follows 35 Re8+.

In the 16th game of the world championship match **Bronstein-Botvinnik** (1951), the following position was reached:



Without going into the concrete aim of Black's last move, 46 ... Qe8, Bronstein played

47 Qd3?

There followed

47 ... Bxf4 48 exf4 Bh5!

and Bronstein was faced with a difficult choice. An invasion of the enemy pieces on the a-file is threatened after 49 Bg2 Qa8, the knight occupies a menacing position in the centre on e4; in the event of 49 Bxe4 dxe4 50 Qa3 Bf3+ 51 Kg1 Qh5 52 Qe3 Qh3 53 Qf2 h5, the threat of ... h4 is irresistible. Bronstein decides to allow Black the "eternal" knight, but endeavours to get some compensation for

this by occupying the a-file.

49 Qa3 Bxf3+ 50 Rxf3 Rg7

Defending the b7 pawn in the event of the possible attack on it by the queen. There is nothing in 50 ... Qa8, since White will not himself exchange, but reply 51 Rd3, sticking to waiting tactics. The tactical diversion 50 ... Qh5 likewise leads to nothing after 51 Kg2.

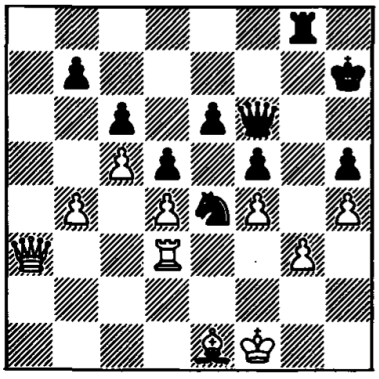
Black's plan consists of creating just a few more weak points in the opponent's camp (for example, by provoking the move h4), then, by attacking them, to divert White's pieces from defence of the a-file and, finally, to occupy this important strategical path of invasion. With support from the "eternal" knight, it will then not be difficult to deliver the concluding blow.

51 Kg2 Qd8 52 Kf1 Qf6 53 Rd3 h5 54 h4

Of course, he cannot allow the move ... h4.

54 ... Rg8

Having in mind, after ... Qg7, by keeping the d4 pawn under attack, to create the threat of invasion via g4.

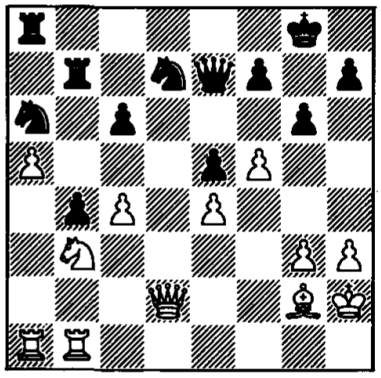


55 Rd1

This rather eases Black's realisation of his positional advantage, but what can he do? If 55 Qa7, then 55 ... Qg7, and White is in zugzwang. 56 Qb6 is not possible in view of 56 ... Ra8, while, upon the retreat of the queen along the a-file, follows ... Qg4.

55 ... Qg7 56 Qf3 Kh6 57 Kg2 Ra8 and Black won.

The struggle was concluded with the "eternal" knight in the game **Terpugov-Bronstein**, (19th USSR Championship 1951):



30 Rb2 Ndc5 31 Nxc5 Qxc5 32 f6

Not only a useless move, in so far as the raid Qh6 is repulsed by the reply ... Qf8, but also a serious positional miscalculation. You see it is clear that Black is dreaming about the transfer of the knight to the invulnerable d4 square. White, however, with his last move, himself takes away control from the e6 square, which is a transit point on the way to this cherished aim. It is not surprising that very soon he

suffers defeat.

Meanwhile it was not an entirely bad position for White. He has available a number of active possibilities. Worth considering, for example, is the pushing of the h-pawn. After 32 h4 it is dangerous to take the c4 pawn with the queen, in view of 33 Rc1. White, however, intends to continue h5, Bh3 and Rf1 with pressure on the king's flank.

32 ... Nc7 33 Ra4 Na6 34 Qh6

Yet another unnecessary thrust, which helps Black to carry out his plan even sooner. The rook is badly placed on a4, as incidentally soon becomes clear, and it should have simply retraced its steps.

34 ... Qf8 35 Qg5

The exchange of queens simplifies the struggle to Black's advantage. The f6 pawn is very weak, it is not easy to realise the plan of invasion on d4. It is natural that White endeavours to complicate the situation as much as possible on the king's flank.

35 ... Nc5!

The bad position of the White rook on a4 tells. It has to go back where it came from, since 36 Raxb4 Rxb4 37 Rxb4 loses the exchange after 37 ... Nxe4.

36 Ra1 h6 37 Qe3

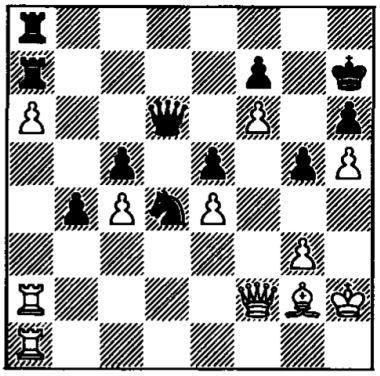
Of course, 37 Qxe5 is not possible, in view of 37 ... Nd3.

37 ... Kh7 38 Rd2 Ne6 39 a6 Rba7 40 Rda2 c5 41 h4 Qd6

On top of everything, White has trouble with the a6 pawn.

42 h5 g5 43 Qf2 Nd4

The knight which every chessplayer "dreams" about.



44 Rd2 Kg8

Black wants, after 45 ... Rxa6 46 Rxa6, to take on a6 with the rook, which at the present moment would not have been possible in view of Rxd4 followed by Qf5+-c8+ with a draw.

45 Rda2

White sealed this move, but then **resigned** without playing on. A correct decision, since after ... Rxa6 the b-pawn, with support from the "eternal" knight reaches the first rank without any trouble.

3: Weak Squares on the sixth (third) rank

One of the most tempting objectives of a plan is to create real weaknesses of squares on the 6th (3rd) ranks. The establishment of a knight or bishop on these squares usually represents just as decisive a positional achievement as obtaining the "eternal" knight. Sometimes these ideas are combined.